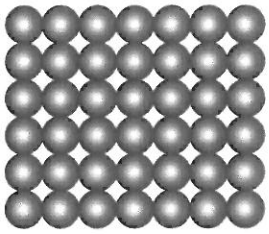
W.S.38. **Solids, liquids and gases.** Name .....

Everything is made up of particles that are too small to see. The three states of matter are SOLID, LIQUID and GAS. They all have different properties due to the arrangement and movement of their particles.

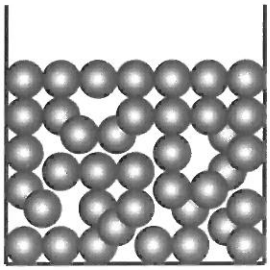
Solids.

The particles are held tightly together by strong forces. They make small vibrations but they stay in place. This gives solids a definite shape and volume. Solids are DENSE (heavy) and they can not be compressed (squashed) easily because the particles are already packed closely together.



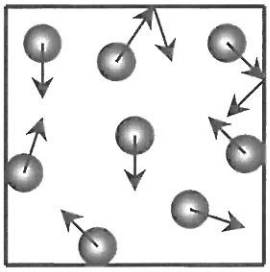
Liquids.

A liquid can flow because the particles can move past each other. The particles are still held closely together by strong forces. Liquids are DENSE and they can not be compressed easily. A liquid can change its shape but not its volume.



Gases.

There are only very weak forces between the particles which are far apart. The particles move around very quickly and bounce off each other. Gases have a low density (they are very light) and they do not have a definite shape or volume.



Exercise - Complete the spaces in the table below.

Property	Solids	Liquids	Gases
Density (heavy or light)	High density (heavy)		Low density (light)
How easy are they to compress (squash)?	Hard		Easy
Do they flow?		Yes	Yes
Do they keep the same shape?		No	
Do they keep the same volume?	Yes		

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